

STARPOWER

Episode: Spalling

Scene 1: Ray, a Star Ranger in training wakes up Stardust, a green mudpuppy salamander, who is sleeping inside of the rocket, Friendship, on planet Bory Alice.

RAY

Stardust! Wake up little friend! I received an alert on my warp watch that our buddy Rocky the Rock is stranded on Kepler- 10v! His rocket won't power up and he can't get home. We need to get Friendship fired up and execute a rescue!

STARDUST

(questioning) Twinkle....?

RAY

I'm not sure what happened. But time is of the essence. Kepler- 10v is volcanic, and we need to get there- and get out of there- before the next eruption.

STARDUST

(concerned) Twinkle.

RAY

I know it sounds dangerous, but I also know the two of us- with Friendship guiding the way- can manage.

STARDUST

(demanding) Twinkle. Twinkle. Twinkle.

RAY

Shhhh. No! I don't want to wake up Aurora and StarPower. Stardust, this is just the type of mission that will gain me points toward my Newton badge. I'm SO close to becoming a Star Ranger! I just have to prove I can do a solo mission.

STARDUST

(jealous) Twinkle!

RAY

Solo- meaning without Aurora, silly. I know I can't do it without you.

Programming Friendship's main panel.

RAY

Now, all I have to do is program Friendship to the Kepler-10v planet and he'll take us right there. Piece of cake!

STARDUST

(excited) Twinkle!

RAY

Not real cake, Stardust...maybe on the way back we can stop off at the Soda Pop Shop on Rocketland for some cake and Rocket Fizz.

FRIENDSHIP

P-O-W-E-R-I-N-G up.

The Friendship rocket makes musical noise and its lights flash on, then off, then on and off again. The music dwindles out.

STARDUST

(concerned) Twinkle....

RAY

I know, I know. Aurora was tinkering with Friendship last night, but I'm confident he's ready and able to get the job done. Just give him a minute.

The Friendship rocket makes musical noise, and its lights flash on and stay on.

FRIENDSHIP, RAY, & STARDUST

ROCKET ZOO

Surveying the universe
With friends by my side
Exploring planets & stars
I'll be the guide

Rocket Zoop
Zoop Zoop
Loop and swoop
Zoop Zoop
Alley oop
Zoop Zoop
And then home again!

Traveling through worm holes
Stay near or go far
Science is our guide
Friendship is our North Star

Rocket Zoop
Zoop Zoop

Loop and swoop
Zoop Zoop
Alley oop
Zoop Zoop
And then home again!

Curiosity leads the way
Connection makes us stay
Friends forever
In plasma soup

Rocket Zoop
Zoop Zoop
Loop and swoop
Zoop Zoop
Alley oop
Zoop Zoop
And then home again!

During the song, Friendship, Ray, and Stardust fly into space and around the playing space. As the song ends, there is much turbulence, Friendship's heat shield breaks away and disappears into a void. Friendship experiences a rough landing on the rocky planet, Kepler- 10v. Ray and Stardust exit Friendship.

Scene 2: Kepler- 10v.

RAY

Stardust, are you OK? That was a bumpy ride! *(calling)* Rocky! Rocky?!

STARDUST

(indicating the missing heat shield) Twinkle.

RAY

Uh-oh. This doesn't look good....I think we lost a heat shield panel during the rough descent.

FRIENDSHIP

A heat shield is a protective shield that keeps me from melting when I plunge back down through the atmosphere on the way back from a mission.

STARDUST

TWINKLE!

ROCKY THE ROCK

Ray! Stardust! Over here!

RAY

Rocky! Good to see you, buddy!

ROCKY THE ROCK

Let's get out of here. This volcano has been a rumblin'!!

STARDUST

(worried) Twinkle....

RAY

We may have a small problem, Rocky. It seems Friendship had a loose heat shield panel, and we lost it upon entry into the Kepler atmosphere. Aurora was tinkering with Friendship last night, and I guess maybe he wasn't 100% ready for a mission.... It'll be fine. Just point us in the direction of your rocket and we can transfer one of its heat shield panels to Friendship.

ROCKY THE ROCK

Impossible.

RAY

What do you mean? Why?

ROCKY THE ROCK

Rocket not just lose power. Rocket gone.

STARDUST

(very worried) TWINKLE!

RAY

What?! How?! Is there nothing salvageable?

ROCKY THE ROCK

Rocket inside volcano.

RAY

NO! What happened?!

ROCKY THE ROCK

Unexpected solar windstorm.

FRIENDSHIP

A solar windstorm is a massive eruption of energy, magnetic fields, and electrified gas called plasma, that is blasted from a sun into its solar system.

STARDUST

(questioning, curious) Twinkle?

FRIENDSHIP

Plasma is considered the 4th state of matter, it is an electrified, super-heated gas, where the atoms smash into each other so hard that their electrons get ripped away. This leaves behind free-floating negative electrons and positive ions that create a magnetic field.

ROCKY THE ROCK

Solar windstorm bad! Nowhere to take cover. Me wedged between rocks. Got signal on warp watch after storm. Called Aurora. Aurora no answer. Call you.

RAY

Yeah....Aurora was sleeping. She was up late working on Friendship..... I guess now I know why.

ROCKY THE ROCK

What to do?!

STARDUST

(defeated) Twinkle.

RAY

We can't call her. She'll be SO mad at me!

The volcano rumbles.

ROCKY THE ROCK

Suggest: eat crow.

STARDUST

(confused) Twinkle?

RAY

It's an expression, Stardust.

FRIENDSHIP

Eat crow: to admit you were completely wrong and accept humiliation. Typically, after being over-confident...

RAY

Ok.

FRIENDSHIP

....arrogant....cavalier.

RAY

Ok, OK!

Music begins to play from inside of Friendship.

RAY, STARDUST, ROCKY THE ROCK & FRIENDSHIP

EAT CROW

I thought I could manage on my own
Me, myself, and I
A lone wolf, a maverick
Now I'm eating humble pie

When you think you know
When you're sure you know
But you don't really know
You gotta make that call and ask for help
You gotta eat that crow!
(Crow! Crow! Crow!
You gotta eat
Crow! Crow! Crow!)

I thought I could manage on my own
With no Aurora by my side
A hero Ranger all by myself
Now I'm swallowing my pride

When you think you know
When you're sure you know
But you don't really know
You gotta make that call and ask for help
You gotta eat that crow!
(Crow! Crow! Crow!
You gotta eat
Crow! Crow! Crow!)

I want my Newton badge so much
For that badge I yearn
Now it feels so out of touch
When will I ever learn?

When you think you know
When you're sure you know
But you don't really know
You gotta make that call and ask for help
You gotta eat that crow!
(Crow! Crow! Crow!
You gotta eat
Crow! Crow! Crow!)

Scene 3: Aurora has woken up on planet Bory Alice. She is looking out into space using Telescope. StarPower sits on her shoulder.

AURORA

They'll never learn!

STARPOWER

(affirming) Bubble.

AURORA

Ray is so eager to get their Newton Badge and become a full-fledged Star Ranger that they are making foolish decisions.

STARPOWER

Bubble.

AURORA

What is your assessment, Telescope?

TELESCOPE

Kepler- 10v. V for volcanic. Looks like they are stranded with a missing heat shield panel, and time is of the essence.

AURORA

Do you think we'll have time to stop on Rocketland and get a spare heat shield panel from Clay at the rocket factory?

TELESCOPE

That's a negative.

STARPOWER

(concerned) Bubble.....

AURORA

Time to fire up Ances-Star. I don't see another way.

STARPOWER

(questioning) Bubble?

AURORA

Don't worry, StarPower. She's an older model but she still flies just fine. But we *are* going to need you and your super shapeshifting abilities once we arrive on the Kepler planet. Are you up for it?

STARPOWER

(enthusiastic) Bubble! Bubble!

Aurora opens a closet and brings out Ances-Star. She manually flips gears and starts the rocket up. It is old and clunky compared to Friendship.

STARPOWER

(nervous) Bubble.....

AURORA

It's going to be just fine.

As Aurora and StarPower climb into Ances-Star, Ray contacts them through his warp watch.

RAY

Aurora. Now listen, please don't be mad. I know you're probably wondering where I am and upset that I fired up Friendship without telling you. I was wrong to do that, I admit it. But we need your help.

AURORA

We can talk about your actions later, Ray. Telescope has already located you on Kepler 10v. StarPower and I are on our way.

RAY

Thank goodness! This volcano is going to blow!!

Scene 4: Aurora and StarPower arrive on Kepler- 10v to rescue Ray, Stardust, and Rocky the Rock.

STARDUST

(excited) Twinkle! Twinkle!

RAY

Aurora! StarPower! Over here!

ROCKY THE ROCK

Rescue! Happy!

FRIENDSHIP

Ray was hasty and fired me up before I was ready-- before you were able to fix my loose bolts and secure my heat shield.

AURORA

Hasty indeed.

RAY

I'm sorry, Aurora. I'll do anything to make it up to you. I was excited to get the call and help Rocky. I wanted to impress you with a successful solo mission and I botched everything up.

The volcano rumbles.

AURORA

We can talk about it later. We need to get out of here before the volcano erupts.

RAY

But can I still get points toward my Newton Badge??

AURORA

Later, Ray.

RAY

OK.

FRIENDSHIP

Were you able to stop on Rocketland and get a new heat shield panel from Clay?

AURORA

No time for that. StarPower will provide a temporary fix. We can swing by Rocketland on the way home. Are you ready, StarPower? Everyone, form a circle.

They all form a circle around StarPower and chant.

ALL

StarPower magic, around you we swarm. Like a caterpillar to a butterfly, morph and transform. StarPower magic, around you we swarm. Like a caterpillar to a butterfly, morph and transform.

AURORA

(to audience) And by magic, we mean science!

StarPower shapeshifts into a heat panel as the volcano erupts. Aurora quickly attaches her, in her new form, onto Friendship. The rumbling of the volcano gets louder and louder as it is erupting. They fire up both rockets, pile in, and take off.

ROCKY THE ROCK

Plasma storm!! Launch!!

Scene 5: Both rockets arrive on Rocketland.

RAY

That was intense.

They pile out of the rockets and StarPower transforms back into her salamander self. Clay is tinkering with a rocket in his shop.

AURORA

Well done, StarPower!

STARPOWER

Bubble!

CLAY

Visitors!

AURORA

Hey, Clay. What are you working on?

CLAY

Hey, friends. I'm just upgrading a model 4114 rocket so that it syncs with the new warp communication devices. What brings you to Rocketland?

RAY

Friendship needs a new heat shield panel.

CLAY

Ahhh. Got one right in my spare parts pile. How did you get here with a missing heat shield panel?

AURORA

StarPower took one for the team and provided a temporary fix.

CLAY

Amazing shapeshifting abilities, StarPower! Let me just attach the new heat shield panel and you can be on your way.

Clay attaches the heat shield panel onto Friendship.

STARDUST

Twinkle. Twinkle.

RAY

Stardust is wondering if there might be time for a stop off at the Soda Pop Shop for some cake and Rocket Fizz.....what do you think, Aurora?

ROCKY THE ROCK

Rocket Fizz!

STARPOWER

Bubble! Bubble!

AURORA

I suppose. There's nothing like Rocket Fizz to help us relax after a stressful day.

They all walk over to the nearby Soda Pop Shop. It is a self-serve counter where they help themselves to cupcakes.

RAY

Cupcakes are much better than crow! What kind of Rocket Fizz do you want, Stardust?

STARDUST

Twinkle!

RAY

Bacon it is! How about you, StarPower?

STARPOWER

Bubble!

RAY

Pickle it is! How about you, Rocky?

ROCKY THE ROCK

Rocky Road, of course!

Ray pours all the drinks and serves the friends.

CLAY

Cheers, everyone!

They all finish at the Soda Pop Shop and head back to the rockets to head home.

ALL

Bye, Clay! Thank you!

ALL

ROCKET ZOOP Reprise

Rocket Zoop

Zoop Zoop

Loop and swoop

Zoop Zoop

Alley oop

Zoop Zoop

And then home again!

Rocket Zoop
Zoop Zoop
Loop and swoop
Zoop Zoop
Alley oop
Zoop Zoop
And then home again!

They power up, launch, and head back to Bory Alice.

Scene 6: All arrive back on planet Bory Alice.

AURORA

Home sweet, home.

STARPOWER

Bubble.

STARDUST

Twinkle.

RAY

Another adventure. Another lesson learned.

AURORA

Friends! Let's *review* what we've learned! Ray, why don't you go first-

RAY

I learned that I should not be so eager to earn my Newton Badge that I skip over important steps, especially communicating what I'm doing.... I also learned some new terms!

The following terms come up on Friendship's panels with pictures.

FRIENDSHIP

Heat Shield

AURORA

A heat shield is a protective shield that keeps a rocket from melting when it re-enters an atmosphere on the way back from a mission.

FRIENDSHIP

Plasma

AURORA

Plasma is considered the 4th state of matter, it is an electrified, super-heated gas whose atoms smash into each other so hard that their electrons get ripped away. This leaves behind free-floating negative electrons and positive ions that create a magnetic field.

ROCKY THE ROCK

Plasma 99% of visible universe!

RAY

The sun and stars are giant balls of burning plasma and lightning bolts and the Northern Lights are real-life examples on planet Earth.

FRIENDSHIP

Solar Windstorm

AURORA

A solar windstorm is a massive eruption of energy, magnetic fields, and plasma blasted from a sun into its solar system.

FRIENDSHIP

Rocket Fizz

RAY

Rocket Fizz is an eccentric drink with wild flavors that you enjoy with friends!

STARDUST

Twinkle!

ALL

Friendship is our north star. Science is our superpower!

Friendship lights up and music starts.

ALL

LET'S GO

Let's go to the Cosmos
Venture up through the sky
Let's discover new planets
It's freedom to fly

We'll travel past asteroids
We'll soar past a Moon
We'll see constellations
We can't leave too soon

Let's go, let's fly
Adventure is why
Let's go, me & you
Science is true!
(Friendship is our north star, science is our superpower!)

Let's orbit a Sun
Venture up through a cloud
Let's get our Star Badges
Making everyone proud

When the adventure is over
When we're done with our roam
Let's go to the planet
That we all call home
(Let's go home!)

Let's go, let's fly
Adventure is why
Let's go, me & you
Science is true!
(Friendship is our north star, science is our superpower!)

THE END